CAKE AUX OLIVES

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	TOTAL TIME	OVEN
1 loaf, 23 by 12 cm, 6 to 8 servings	**20 min**	**about 2 h 30 min**	**325F for about 1 h**

INGREDIENTS

275 g	Bread flour
2 1/2 tsp	Baking powder
120 ml	White wine
120 ml	Dry white vermouth
4	Eggs, large
210 ml	Olive oil
200 g	Ham, chopped
140 g	Gruyère cheese, grated
115 g	Olives, pitted and coarsely chopped
1 1/2 tbsp	Thyme leaves, fresh
1 tsp	Salt
1/2 tsp	Black pepper, freshly ground

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 325F. Butter the base and sides of a 23 by 12 cm loaf pan lightly, then line it with parchment and leave several centimetres standing above the rim.
2. Tip in the baking powder, flour, wine, vermouth and eggs. A stand mixer on the paddle handles this, and so does a bowl and a wooden spoon. Work on medium until the mixture pulls together.
3. Keep the mixer on medium and pour the olive oil in slowly, as a thin steady trickle, until it has all been taken up and the dough looks elastic.
4. Toss the olives, ham, Gruyère, thyme, salt and pepper together in a second bowl.
5. Fold that mixture through the batter with a spatula or a wooden spoon, stopping the moment it is evenly distributed.
6. Scrape the batter into the lined pan and level the top with an offset spatula.
7. Bake about 1 hour, until a cake tester comes out of the centre clean.
8. Leave the loaf in the pan on a wire rack about 20 minutes, then turn it out, set it the right way up and let it go completely cold.
9. Serve at room temperature.

NOTES

This is the rare batter you want to work rather than protect. Mix until the dough shows elasticity and strings off the paddle as you lift it.
The 210 ml of olive oil is what stops all that gluten development turning the crumb tough.
The parchment overhang gives you handles, which a heavy oil-rich loaf needs to come out of the pan in one piece.
Wrapped well, it holds 2 days at room temperature or about a week in the refrigerator.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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